

**This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.**

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Fluconazole or Clotrimazole for the treatment of Vaginal Thrush (Vulvovaginal Candidiasis)

## Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Vaginal Thrush (Vulvovaginal Candidiasis)

### Overview

Vulvovaginal candidiasis is a common fungal infection caused by *Candida albicans*, affecting the vulva and vaginal tissues.

### Assessment

- **Symptoms:** Vulval itching, vaginal discharge (typically thick, white, curdy), vaginal soreness, vulval erythema, and pain during intercourse or micturition.

### Management

- **First-line treatment:** Oral antifungal (fluconazole 150mg single dose) or topical antifungal (clotrimazole 500mg pessary single dose).

### Red flags requiring referral or specialist advice

- **Recurrent infection:** 4 or more episodes per year - refer to GP for further investigation.
- **Immunocompromised patients:** Require careful management and GP referral.
- **Pregnancy:** Topical antifungal only; oral fluconazole contraindicated in pregnancy.

## Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

**Fluconazole 150mg capsule**

for the treatment of

**Vaginal Thrush (Vulvovaginal Candidiasis)**

### Healthcare professionals covered and training

|                                 | Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Qualifications and Registration | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC</li><li>• Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC</li></ul>                                                                                                                                    |
| Training and assessment         | <p>Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as</li></ul> |

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|                                              | <p>well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication</li> <li>• Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer</li> <li>• All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service</li> </ul>     |
| <b>Further training and responsibilities</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal</li> <li>• All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products</li> <li>• All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.</li> </ul> |

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|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>PGD Indication</b>                                       | Treatment of uncomplicated vulvovaginal candidiasis in non-pregnant women aged 16-65 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Inclusion criteria</b>                                   | <p>Women aged 16-65 years</p> <p>Clinical diagnosis of uncomplicated vulvovaginal candidiasis</p> <p>Not pregnant or breastfeeding</p> <p>No contraindications</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Exclusion criteria</b>                                   | <p>Pregnancy</p> <p>Breastfeeding (relative contraindication due to insufficient data)</p> <p>Known hypersensitivity to fluconazole or azoles</p> <p>Concurrent use of terfenadine, astemizole, cisapride, or pimozide (risk of QT prolongation and torsades de pointes)</p> <p>Severe hepatic impairment (Child-Pugh score &gt; 9)</p> <p>Severe renal impairment (eGFR &lt; 20 mL/min)</p> <p>History of QT prolongation or cardiac arrhythmias</p> |
| <b>Cautions</b>                                             | <p>Hepatic impairment (mild to moderate) - monitor closely</p> <p>Renal impairment (mild to moderate) - dose adjustment may be needed</p> <p>Drug interactions: warfarin and other oral anticoagulants (increased anticoagulant effect), statins (increased statin levels), phenytoin (increased phenytoin levels), rifampicin (reduced fluconazole levels)</p> <p>Consider other medication interactions via BNF</p>                                 |
| <b>Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment</b> | <p>Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed.</p> <p>Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

### Details of the medicine

|                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
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| <b>Name, form and strength of medicine</b>         | Fluconazole 150mg capsule                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Legal category</b>                              | POM                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Storage</b>                                     | Store below 25°C in a dry place. Keep out of reach of children.                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Route/method of administration</b>              | Oral, swallowed whole                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>                          | Single dose of 150mg orally                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Quantity to be administered and/or supplied</b> | 1 capsule (150mg)                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Maximum or minimum treatment period</b>         | Single dose; no further treatment required unless symptoms persist                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>                             | Common: nausea, abdominal pain, diarrhoea, headache<br>Uncommon: rash, pruritus, dizziness<br>Rare: hepatotoxicity (raised liver enzymes, hepatitis), anaphylaxis, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, toxic epidermal necrolysis |

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| <b>Yellow card reporting</b> | Report suspected adverse effects via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP as appropriate.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Records to be kept</b>    | <p>Record the following information:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• that valid informed consent was given</li><li>• name of individual, address, date of birth and GP</li><li>• name of healthcare practitioner</li><li>• name and brand of medication</li><li>• date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied</li><li>• advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment</li><li>• details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD</li></ul> <p>Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made.</p> <p>A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years</li><li>• Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)</li></ul> |

### Patient information

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| <b>Written information to be given to patient or carer</b> | Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer</b>    | <p>Symptoms should resolve within 5-7 days. If symptoms persist or worsen, contact your GP.</p> <p>Wear cotton underwear and avoid irritants such as douches, scented products, and tight clothing.</p> <p>Avoid sexual intercourse for at least 5 days after treatment (pessary may damage condoms/diaphragms).</p> <p>If using the pessary, insert with fingers rather than the applicator to minimize damage to barriers.</p> <p>If you experience recurrent infections (4 or more per year), contact your GP for investigation.</p> <p>Complete the full course of treatment as prescribed.</p> <p>Report any adverse effects to your healthcare provider or via the Yellow Card scheme.</p> |

## Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance: Vulvovaginal candidiasis
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

## Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

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| Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates |           |                     |           |
|                                                                                   |           |                     |           |
| Name of healthcare professional                                                   | Job title | Registration number | Signature |
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| Valid from date | Expiry date |  |  |
| 1/11/25         | 31/7/27     |  |  |

### PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

| Name of superintendent / clinical lead | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|
|                                        |                                  |           |      |
| Name of professional group signatory   | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|                                        |                                  |           |      |

### Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

| Name             | Qualification                  | Signature                                                                            | Date    |
|------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Nitin Shori      | Medical Doctor<br>GMC: 6047293 |   | 2/11/25 |
| Chris Pilkington | Pharmacist<br>GPhC: 2046322    |  | 2/11/25 |

### Change history

| Version number | Change details                 | Date              |
|----------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|
| 001            | Development & issue of new PGD | 1st November 2025 |

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**Patient Group Direction**  
for the supply/administration of  
**Clotrimazole 500mg vaginal pessary**  
for the treatment of  
**Vaginal Thrush (Vulvovaginal Candidiasis)**

**Healthcare professionals covered and training**

|                                              | <b>Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Qualifications and Registration</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> <li>• Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Training and assessment</b>               | <p>Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines</li> <li>• All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication</li> <li>• Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer</li> <li>• All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service</li> </ul> |
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| <b>PGD Indication</b>     | Treatment of uncomplicated vulvovaginal candidiasis in non-pregnant women aged 16-65 years                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Inclusion criteria</b> | <p>Women aged 16-65 years</p> <p>Clinical diagnosis of uncomplicated vulvovaginal candidiasis</p> <p>No contraindications</p> <p>Able to insert pessary intravaginally</p>                                 |
| <b>Exclusion criteria</b> | Known hypersensitivity to clotrimazole or imidazoles                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Cautions</b>           | <p>Pregnancy (topical antifungals are safe in pregnancy, but applicator should not be used; advise to insert pessary with fingers)</p> <p>May damage latex condoms and diaphragms - advise alternative</p> |

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|                                                             | <p>contraception for 5 days after use</p> <p>Ensure patient can retain pessary (abnormal anatomy, severe prolapse)</p>                                                             |
| <b>Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment</b> | <p>Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed.</p> <p>Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.</p> |

### *Details of the medicine*

|                                                    |                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name, form and strength of medicine</b>         | Clotrimazole 500mg vaginal pessary                                                                                                    |
| <b>Legal category</b>                              | POM                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Storage</b>                                     | Store below 25°C in a dry place. Keep out of reach of children.                                                                       |
| <b>Route/method of administration</b>              | Intravaginal insertion at bedtime                                                                                                     |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>                          | Single 500mg pessary inserted intravaginally at night                                                                                 |
| <b>Quantity to be administered and/or supplied</b> | 1 pessary (500mg)                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Maximum or minimum treatment period</b>         | Single application; treatment completed in one night                                                                                  |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>                             | <p>Common: local vaginal irritation, burning sensation, vaginal erythema</p> <p>Uncommon: vaginal candidiasis (rebound infection)</p> |

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| <b>Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer</b>    | <p>Symptoms should resolve within 5-7 days. If symptoms persist or worsen, contact your GP.</p> <p>Wear cotton underwear and avoid irritants such as douches, scented products, and tight clothing.</p> <p>Avoid sexual intercourse for at least 5 days after treatment (pessary may damage condoms/diaphragms).</p> <p>If using the pessary, insert with fingers rather than the applicator to minimize damage to barriers.</p> <p>If you experience recurrent infections (4 or more per year), contact your GP for investigation.</p> <p>Complete the full course of treatment as prescribed.</p> <p>Report any adverse effects to your healthcare provider or via the Yellow Card scheme.</p> |

### **Key references**

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| Name of healthcare professional | Job title   | Registration number | Signature |
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|                                        |                                  |           |      |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|
| Name of superintendent / clinical lead | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|                                        |                                  |           |      |
| Name of professional group signatory   | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|                                        |                                  |           |      |

#### **Signed on behalf of Get Real Health**

|             |                                |                                                                                     |             |
|-------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Name</b> | <b>Qualification</b>           | <b>Signature</b>                                                                    | <b>Date</b> |
| Nitin Shori | Medical Doctor<br>GMC: 6047293 |  | 2/11/25     |

|                  |                             |                                                                                    |         |
|------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Chris Pilkington | Pharmacist<br>GPhC: 2046322 |  | 2/11/25 |
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### Change history

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| 001            | Development & issue of new PGD | 1st November 2025 |
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